



SEC Charges Three Texans with Defrauding Investors in \$91 Million Ponzi Scheme

The Securities and Exchange Commission today announced charges against Dallas-Fort Worth residents Kenneth W. Alexander II, Robert D. Welsh, and Caedrynn E. Conner for operating a Ponzi scheme that raised at least \$91 million from more than 200 investors. According to the SEC's complaint, between approximately May 2021 and February 2024, Alexander and Welsh operated the scheme through a trust controlled by Alexander called Vanguard Holdings Group Irrevocable Trust (VHG). They falsely represented that investors would receive 12 guaranteed monthly payments of between 3% and 6% per month, with the principal investment to be returned after 14 months, according to the complaint. The SEC alleges that Alexander and Welsh held VHG out as a highly profitable international bond trading business with billions in assets, and told investors that the monthly returns were generated from international bond trading and related activities.

Regulator Identifier: SEC

<https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2025-71>



SEC Publishes New Market Data, Analysis, and Visualizations

The Securities and Exchange Commission's Division of Economic and Risk Analysis (DERA) has published new data and analysis on the key market areas of public issuers, exempt offerings, Commercial Mortgage-Backed Securities (CMBS), Asset-Backed Securities (ABS), money market funds, and security-based swap dealers (SBSD) in an effort to increase transparency and understanding of our capital markets amongst the public. "These reports reflect important information that is valuable to investors, other market participants, and academics," said Robert Fisher, Acting Chief Economist and Director of the SEC's Division of Economic and Risk Analysis.

Regulator Identifier: SEC

<https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2025-70>



SEC Charges PGI Global Founder with \$198 Million Crypto Asset and Foreign Exchange Fraud Scheme

The Securities and Exchange Commission today charged Ramil Palafox for orchestrating a fraudulent scheme that raised approximately \$198 million from investors worldwide and for misappropriating more than \$57 million of investor funds. According to the SEC's complaint, Palafox's company, known as PGI Global, claimed to be a crypto asset and foreign exchange trading company. From January 2020 through October 2021, Palafox offered and sold PGI Global "membership" packages, which he claimed guaranteed investors high returns from PGI Global's supposed crypto asset and foreign exchange trading and offered members multi-level-marketing-like referral incentives to encourage them to recruit new investors. However, as the complaint alleges, Palafox misappropriated more than \$57 million in investor funds to buy Lamborghinis, items from luxury retailers, and for other personal expenses.

Regulator Identifier: SEC

<https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2025-69>